Hazard Reporting Policy

Policy Summary & Knowledge Check

Authority	Board of Directors
Date Ratified	December 6, 2024
Next Review Date	December 2027
Previous Amendments	February 16, 2018; October 30, 2012

Policy Summary

This policy outlines the procedure for reporting hazardous situations that may endanger the health and safety of individuals. It applies to all USC employees, volunteers, and visitors for any hazard that cannot be corrected instantly, requires further investigation, or raises significant concern. It defines key terms (hazard, serious hazard, unsafe acts, unsafe conditions) and sets out the responsibilities of workers, supervisors/managers, and the Health & Safety Coordinator in reporting, rating, and remediating hazards.

Key Takeaways

- Applies to all USC employees, volunteers, and visitors, for any hazard that cannot be corrected instantly, needs further investigation, or raises significant concern.
- A "hazard" is a condition or situation with the potential to cause injury, illness, property damage, or disruption of work operations; a "serious hazard" poses a considerable risk of injury, illness, death, or harm.
- Workers must report any significant hazard they become aware of to their supervisor/manager, and must report both the hazard and any remedy they personally make.
- The supervisor/manager of the worker reporting a hazard must follow up with a timely response or action to maintain safe and healthy working conditions.
- Supervisors/managers must ensure the Health & Safety Coordinator receives copies of the hazard report for distribution to USC Occupational Health & Safety, the Joint Health & Safety Committee (JHSC), and the Worker Health & Safety Representative.
- Reporting a hazard must be done immediately and verbally, and using the Hazard Reporting Form if the hazard is significant or the worker wants it documented in writing.
- The supervisor/manager, with the assistance of the worker, rates the hazard, forms an action plan, implements it, and notifies necessary parties through the Health & Safety Coordinator.

Knowledge Check

4 situational questions to check understanding of this policy. An answer key follows on the next page.

Q1. A worker notices a loose stairwell handrail that poses a real risk of injury but cannot fix it themselves. What should they do?

A. Report the hazard to their supervisor/manager immediately and verbally, using the Hazard Reporting Form if it is significant.

B. Wait until the next scheduled inspection to mention it.

C. Post a handwritten note near the handrail and move on.

D. Ignore it, since it isn't part of their job.

Q2. A worker personally tightens a loose cable that was creating a trip hazard. What is required afterward?

A. Nothing further, since the hazard was already fixed.

B. Report both the hazard and the remedy made to their supervisor/manager.

C. Only report it if someone was actually injured.

D. File a formal report directly with the Board of Directors.

Q3. Who is responsible for ensuring the Health & Safety Coordinator receives copies of a hazard report for distribution to the JHSC and Worker Health & Safety Representative?

A. USC Occupational Health & Safety only.

B. The worker who first identified the hazard.

C. The supervisor/manager of the worker reporting the hazard.

D. The Board of Directors.

Q4. Which of these best matches the policy's definition of a "serious hazard"?

A. Any hazard that has been reported more than once.

B. A hazard identified only during an annual inspection.

C. A minor cosmetic issue with no safety impact.

D. A condition, activity, or situation posing a considerable risk of injury, illness, death, or harm.

Answer Key

Q1: A — Sections 3.1 and 4.1 require workers to report significant hazards to their supervisor/manager immediately and verbally, using the Hazard Reporting Form where appropriate.

Q2: B — Section 3.2 states a worker who remedies a significant hazard will report both the hazard and the remedy made to their supervisor/manager.

Q3: C — Section 3.4 places responsibility on the supervisor/manager of the reporting worker to ensure the Health & Safety Coordinator receives copies for distribution.

Q4: D — Section 2.3 defines a serious hazard as a condition, activity, or situation that poses a considerable risk of injury, illness, death, or harm to individuals.